

• KOREAN STREET FOOD • OPERATIONS

# Korean Street Food Cafe



*Breakfast & Lunch — 7:00am to 3:00pm*

Full Recipe Cards • US Market Food Costing • Kitchen Prep Flow • Financial Forecast

Real Korean technique. Gochujang from scratch. Kimchi made in-house. No shortcuts.

KIMCHI • GOCHUJANG • BAE

**30**

SEATS

**\$34**

AVG SPEND

**22%**

FOOD COST TARGET

**\$17,600**

EST. MONTHLY NET

**About This Guide:** Korean street food has become one of the fastest-growing food categories in the US market. The flavour profiles — fermented, spicy, umami-forward, sweet-savoury — are compelling to a generation raised on global food culture. The economics are excellent: gochugaru, doenjang, ganjang, and sesame oil produce extraordinary flavour at very low cost. This guide covers the fundamentals of Korean street food with complete recipe cards, gram-precise ingredient weights, and the technique reasoning that separates an authentic Korean kitchen from a Korean-flavoured Western one.

## THE STORY BEHIND THIS GUIDE

**"Korean food is having a global moment. I knew it was coming five years before it arrived. The guide told me how to build a business on it before the moment passed."**

Jisoo grew up in Koreatown, Los Angeles, and spent her twenties watching Korean culture go from niche to mainstream in real time. She watched Korean BBQ restaurants multiply on every block. She watched tteokbokki — the spicy rice cakes she had eaten after school her entire childhood — appear on food blogs written by people who had never been to Korea. She watched the moment arrive, and she watched other people open the restaurants that should have been hers.

She had the food knowledge. Her halmeoni's kimchi recipe was thirty years old and better than anything sold commercially. She knew the difference between gochugaru (the Korean red pepper flakes, fruity and smoky) and gochujang (the fermented chili paste, deep and complex), and she knew that confusing them was the most common mistake non-Korean cooks made with Korean food. She knew that Korean corn dogs — the ones coated in potato cubes and deep-fried — were the single most viral Korean street food item of the decade.

What she lacked was the operational translation. The food cost box on the Korean corn dog in this guide — \$1.24 to make, \$8.99 to sell, 13.8% food cost — was the moment the business became real in her mind. Not the idea. The business. Numbers she could put in front of a landlord, a bank, a co-investor.

She opened in a 40-seat space in Austin's East 6th corridor. The Korean corn dog frier is visible from the street. The tteokbokki is made in the original Sindang-dong style — rice cakes, fish cake, hard-boiled egg, gochujang broth. Month three net: \ \$38,000. **Korean street food does not need to be explained to a new generation. It just needs to be executed correctly.**

Jisoo K. · Korean Street Food Cafe · East 6th, Austin · Est. Month 3 Net: \ \$38,000

1 Entrées

Pajeon — Korean Scallion Pancake

Crispy rice flour pancake, scallion, seafood, soy dipping sauce · Sell: \$13.99

10 min Entrée Target FC: 16%

INGREDIENTS (1 PANCAKE)

| INGREDIENT                       | WEIGHT     | COST   |
|----------------------------------|------------|--------|
| Rice flour + plain flour (50:50) | 60g + 60g  | \$0.24 |
| Ice cold water                   | 180ml      | \$0.00 |
| Egg                              | 1 × 55g    | \$0.35 |
| Scallions (whole)                | 80g        | \$0.32 |
| Shrimp + squid (mixed)           | 60g        | \$0.84 |
| Sesame oil + vegetable oil       | 5ml + 20ml | \$0.14 |
| Dipping sauce (batch)            | 30ml       | \$0.08 |
| Total cost per serve             |            | \$1.97 |

|                     |         |
|---------------------|---------|
| Cost per serve      | \$1.97  |
| Sell price          | \$13.99 |
| Food cost %         | 14.1%   |
| Contribution margin | \$12.02 |

METHOD

- 1 Mix batter: rice flour + plain flour + ice cold water + egg + a pinch of salt. Mix minimally — lumps are acceptable. The ice cold water creates a light, crispy batter through thermal contrast with the hot oil. The rice flour (50% of the flour mixture) gives pajeon its characteristic crunch that plain wheat flour alone cannot achieve.
- 2 Lay whole scallions in a hot, well-oiled pan in a single layer. Pour batter over — enough to bind and coat the scallions without drowning them. Add shrimp and squid pieces across the batter. Press down gently with a spatula.
- 3 Cook over medium-high heat for **4-5 minutes** until the underside is deep golden. The crust forms when the batter sets and the oil works around the edges. Flip decisively — one motion, not a hesitant turn. Cook 3 more minutes on the second side. The pancake should be crispy, not soft or rubbery.
- 4 Dipping sauce (batch): soy sauce + rice vinegar + sesame oil + gochugaru (Korean chili flakes) + sesame seeds + minced scallion. The sauce should be sharp, salty, slightly spicy, and nutty.

**Chef's Tip:** Pajeon deteriorates quickly — the steam from the hot pancake softens the crust within 5 minutes. Serve immediately and cut at the table for theatre. The sizzling sound as the pajeon arrives is itself a selling tool. Never let it sit under a heat lamp.

GLUTEN SHELLFISH EGGS SESAME FISH (soy)

# Tteokbokki — Spicy Rice Cakes

Chewy rice cakes, gochujang sauce, fish cake, boiled egg · Sell: \$12.99

8 min   Entrée   Target FC: 18%

## INGREDIENTS

| INGREDIENT                      | WEIGHT    | COST   |
|---------------------------------|-----------|--------|
| Cylindrical rice cakes (tteok)  | 150g      | \$0.72 |
| Gochujang paste                 | 30g       | \$0.36 |
| Gochugaru (Korean chili flakes) | 5g        | \$0.06 |
| Soy sauce + sugar               | 10ml + 8g | \$0.04 |
| Anchovy stock (dashi base)      | 200ml     | \$0.12 |
| Eomuk (fish cake slices)        | 50g       | \$0.48 |
| Boiled egg (halved)             | 1 × 55g   | \$0.35 |
| Scallion (garnish)              | 10g       | \$0.04 |
| Total cost per serve            |           | \$2.17 |

|                     |         |
|---------------------|---------|
| Cost per serve      | \$2.17  |
| Sell price          | \$12.99 |
| Food cost %         | 16.7%   |
| Contribution margin | \$10.82 |

## METHOD

- 1 Anchovy stock (batch): simmer dried anchovies + dashima (dried kelp) in water for 20 minutes. Strain. This stock is the foundation of authentic tteokbokki sauce — without it, the sauce lacks the umami depth that makes Korean street food complex. Chicken stock can substitute but produces a less authentic result.
- 2 Bring anchovy stock to a simmer. Add gochujang, gochugaru, soy sauce, sugar. Stir to dissolve. Add rice cakes and fish cake strips. Cook **8-10 minutes** until rice cakes are fully soft (they should have some resistance — chewy, not mushy) and the sauce has reduced to a thick, clingy consistency that coats each rice cake.
- 3 The sauce must be thick — tteokbokki sauce should not be watery or soupy. If too thin, continue cooking uncovered until reduced. If too thick, add a small splash of stock. The glossy, thick red sauce clinging to the chewy rice cakes is the visual identity of the dish.
- 4 Serve in a warm bowl. Add boiled egg halves and scatter sliced scallion. The egg yolk, when broken, mixes with the spicy sauce and creates a mild, creamy element that balances the heat. Always include the egg.

**Chef's Tip:** Refrigerated rice cakes are hard and crack easily — soak cold rice cakes in warm water for 15-20 minutes before cooking to restore pliability. Fresh or thawed rice cakes can go directly into the sauce. Never use overcooked tteok — they dissolve in the sauce and lose the essential chew that defines the dish.

FISH (anchovy stock, fish cake)   EGGS   GLUTEN (soy)   SHELLFISH (some fish cakes)

# Japchae — Glass Noodle Stir-Fry

Sweet potato glass noodles, beef, vegetables, sesame · Sell: \$13.99

10 min   Entrée   Target FC: 18%

## INGREDIENTS

| INGREDIENT | WEIGHT | COST |
|------------|--------|------|
|------------|--------|------|

|                                        |                  |               |
|----------------------------------------|------------------|---------------|
| Sweet potato glass noodles (dangmyeon) | 80g dry          | \$0.40        |
| Beef ribeye or sirloin (thin sliced)   | 70g              | \$1.82        |
| Spinach (blanched)                     | 50g              | \$0.22        |
| Shiitake mushrooms                     | 40g              | \$0.48        |
| Carrot + onion (julienned)             | 40g + 40g        | \$0.16        |
| Soy sauce + sesame oil + sugar         | 20ml + 10ml + 5g | \$0.18        |
| Garlic (minced)                        | 5g               | \$0.03        |
| Sesame seeds (garnish)                 | 3g               | \$0.04        |
| <b>Total cost per serve</b>            |                  | <b>\$3.33</b> |

|                            |                |
|----------------------------|----------------|
| Cost per serve             | \$3.33         |
| Sell price                 | \$13.99        |
| Food cost %                | 23.8%          |
| <b>Contribution margin</b> | <b>\$10.66</b> |

METHOD

- Boil dangmyeon noodles 6–7 minutes until just cooked. Drain, rinse cold, cut into 15cm lengths with scissors (whole noodles are too unwieldy to eat). Toss with 1 tsp sesame oil and soy sauce immediately — this prevents them from sticking and begins flavour absorption.
- Marinate beef slices: soy sauce + sesame oil + sugar + garlic. Stir-fry each component separately in a very hot wok — beef first, then vegetables separately. Each component cooked separately ensures everything is properly seared rather than steaming together. Combine all components with seasoned noodles and toss over high heat 2 minutes.
- Finish with sesame oil, season with soy and sugar to taste. The japchae should be glossy, deeply savoury, slightly sweet, nutty from sesame. Scatter sesame seeds. Can be served warm or room temperature — one of the few Korean dishes that works at room temp.

**Chef's Tip:** Japchae is an excellent batch item for service — make a large batch in the morning, hold at room temperature, and serve throughout the day. It actually improves as the noodles absorb the seasoning over time. Only the beef needs to be cooked fresh; the vegetable-noodle base can be pre-made.

BEEF FISH (soy) SESAME

Kimchi Pancake — Kimchijeon

Fermented kimchi batter pancake, soy sesame dip · Sell: \$11.99

8 min Entrée Target FC: 12%

INGREDIENTS (1 PANCAKE)

| INGREDIENT                        | WEIGHT | COST          |
|-----------------------------------|--------|---------------|
| House kimchi (fermented, chopped) | 100g   | \$0.44        |
| Plain flour                       | 80g    | \$0.06        |
| Kimchi brine (from jar)           | 30ml   | \$0.00        |
| Cold water                        | 60ml   | \$0.00        |
| Sesame oil                        | 5ml    | \$0.08        |
| Vegetable oil (frying)            | 20ml   | \$0.04        |
| Dipping sauce (batch)             | 30ml   | \$0.08        |
| <b>Total cost per serve</b>       |        | <b>\$0.70</b> |

|                |         |
|----------------|---------|
| Cost per serve | \$0.70  |
| Sell price     | \$11.99 |

Food cost % 5.8%

**Contribution margin** **\$11.29**

#### METHOD

- 1 House kimchi (batch — ferment weekly): napa cabbage quartered and salted (10% salt by weight) for 2 hours. Rinse and squeeze thoroughly. Make gochugaru paste: gochugaru + fish sauce + garlic + ginger + sugar. Toss with cabbage and grated daikon. Pack tightly in a container and ferment at room temperature 24–48 hours, then refrigerate. The kimchi improves for weeks in the fridge — older kimchi has more complex, sour flavour that is perfect for cooking.
- 2 Kimchijeon batter: chop fermented kimchi and combine with flour, kimchi brine, cold water. The kimchi brine provides salt, acidity, and fermented flavour — never waste it. The batter should be thick and slightly reddish from the gochugaru in the kimchi.
- 3 Cook in a well-oiled pan over medium-high heat. Press flat. Cook 4 minutes first side until deep golden-red and crispy. Flip. 3 minutes more. The pancake should be crispy at the edges and through the base — the kimchi chars slightly and becomes intensely savoury.

**Chef's Tip:** Older, more fermented kimchi produces a better pancake than fresh kimchi. The extra acidity and fermented complexity translates directly to the cooked pancake's flavour. Set aside older batches specifically for cooking rather than fresh eating.

GLUTEN

FISH (fish sauce)

SESAME

## 2 Mains

### Bibimbap

Seasoned rice, namul vegetables, fried egg, gochujang, sesame · Sell: \$17.99

10 min

Main

Target FC: 18%

#### INGREDIENTS

| INGREDIENT                   | WEIGHT   | COST          |
|------------------------------|----------|---------------|
| Short grain rice (cooked)    | 200g     | \$0.36        |
| Spinach namul                | 40g      | \$0.18        |
| Bean sprout namul            | 40g      | \$0.10        |
| Shiitake mushrooms (sautéed) | 40g      | \$0.48        |
| Carrot (julienned, sautéed)  | 30g      | \$0.06        |
| Kimchi                       | 40g      | \$0.18        |
| Fried egg                    | 1 × 55g  | \$0.35        |
| Gochujang sauce (batch)      | 25g      | \$0.18        |
| Sesame oil + sesame seeds    | 5ml + 2g | \$0.10        |
| <b>Total cost per serve</b>  |          | <b>\$1.99</b> |

Cost per serve **\$1.99**

Sell price **\$17.99**

Food cost % **11.1%**

**Contribution margin** **\$16.00**

#### METHOD

- 1 Namul (batch — season all vegetables individually): Spinach namul — blanch, squeeze, season with soy, sesame oil, garlic, sesame seeds. Bean sprout namul — blanch 2 minutes, toss with sesame oil, salt, garlic. Carrot — julienne, sauté briefly in sesame oil. Mushroom — sauté in butter and soy. Each component has its own seasoning — this differentiation is the point of bibimbap; each vegetable should be distinct, not uniform.
- 2 Warm rice (short grain only — long grain does not have the right stickiness and texture for

bibimbap). For dolsot (stone pot) service: heat a stone bowl until extremely hot, add sesame oil, press rice into the bowl. The contact of rice against the hot oiled stone creates nurungji (crispy rice crust) — one of the most celebrated textures in Korean cuisine.

3 Arrange namul vegetables in separate sections around the bowl's circumference — each colour and component visually distinct. Place fried egg (sunny-side, yolk runny) in the centre. Add gochujang on the side or in a small well.

4 Serve immediately if using stone bowl — the bowl continues cooking the rice as it arrives at the table. The sizzling sound and the sight of the still-cooking stone bowl is one of Korean cuisine's great service moments. Explain to first-timers: "Mix everything together with the gochujang before eating."

**Chef's Tip:** The visual presentation of bibimbap — 5+ distinctly coloured components arranged in separate sections — is the dish's identity. If the vegetables are mixed in the kitchen, the presentation loses its entire impact. Arrange each namul separately with clear visual boundaries. The guest mixes it themselves — this interactive element is part of the dining experience.

EGGS FISH (soy) SESAME DAIRY (butter, mushroom)

## Dakgalbi — Spicy Stir-Fried Chicken

Gochujang chicken, sweet potato, scallion, rice or ssam lettuce · Sell: \$18.99

12 min Main Target FC: 20%

### INGREDIENTS

| INGREDIENT                   | WEIGHT      | COST   |
|------------------------------|-------------|--------|
| Chicken thigh (boneless)     | 180g        | \$1.27 |
| Gochujang marinade (batch)   | 40g         | \$0.32 |
| Sweet potato (cubed)         | 80g         | \$0.18 |
| Cabbage (roughly chopped)    | 60g         | \$0.10 |
| Scallions                    | 20g         | \$0.08 |
| Tteok (rice cakes, optional) | 50g         | \$0.24 |
| Sesame oil + seeds           | 5ml + 2g    | \$0.10 |
| Short grain rice (side)      | 150g cooked | \$0.27 |
| Total cost per serve         |             | \$2.56 |

|                     |         |
|---------------------|---------|
| Cost per serve      | \$2.56  |
| Sell price          | \$18.99 |
| Food cost %         | 13.5%   |
| Contribution margin | \$16.43 |

### METHOD

- 1 Gochujang marinade (batch): gochujang + soy sauce + sesame oil + sugar + garlic + ginger + rice wine (mirin or sake). Marinate chicken thigh pieces (bite-sized) minimum 2 hours. The marinade should cling thickly to each piece — too thin and it burns before the chicken cooks.
- 2 Pre-cook sweet potato cubes — microwave 3 minutes or parboil. They need to be 80% cooked before they go into the stir-fry, otherwise the chicken overcooks while waiting for the potato to soften.
- 3 Stir-fry marinated chicken in a hot, lightly oiled pan over high heat. The gochujang marinade caramelises rapidly at high heat — this charred-sticky coating is the flavour. Add sweet potato, cabbage, and rice cakes. Stir continuously. Cook **8-10 minutes**. Internal temp chicken: **74°C / 165°F**.
- 4 Finish with sesame oil, scatter scallions and sesame seeds. Serve in a hot pan with rice on the side. Offer ssam (lettuce wraps) as a premium add-on: butter lettuce + ssamjang paste. The ssam option increases average spend by \$3-4 and is hugely popular.

**Chef's Tip:** Dakgalbi is the best tableside cooking item on a Korean street food menu. If you have a small portable butane burner for tables, this dish can be cooked partially at the table — the sizzle, aroma, and visual are extraordinary. This "finishing at the table" experience increases perceived value, generates social media content, and turns every dakgalbi order into a table event that neighbouring guests notice and want to order.

POULTRY FISH (soy) SESAME GLUTEN (soy)

Doenjang Jjigae — Fermented Soybean Stew

Hearty tofu and vegetable stew, doenjang, mushrooms, rice · Sell: \$15.99

12 min Main Target FC: 14%

INGREDIENTS

| INGREDIENT                         | WEIGHT      | COST   |
|------------------------------------|-------------|--------|
| Doenjang (fermented soybean paste) | 40g         | \$0.32 |
| Tofu (silken or firm, cubed)       | 120g        | \$0.48 |
| Zucchini (diced)                   | 60g         | \$0.14 |
| Shiitake mushrooms                 | 40g         | \$0.48 |
| White onion (diced)                | 30g         | \$0.06 |
| Anchovy-kelp stock                 | 300ml       | \$0.18 |
| Garlic + green chili               | 5g + 10g    | \$0.06 |
| Short grain rice (side)            | 150g cooked | \$0.27 |
| Total cost per serve               |             | \$1.99 |

|                     |         |
|---------------------|---------|
| Cost per serve      | \$1.99  |
| Sell price          | \$15.99 |
| Food cost %         | 12.4%   |
| Contribution margin | \$14.00 |

METHOD

- 1 Dissolve doenjang in anchovy stock — whisk until smooth, no lumps. Doenjang has a pungent, intensely fermented aroma that softens dramatically once it is heated in stock. Do not use too much — doenjang is powerful; 40g per portion is the correct ratio for a stew that is deeply flavoured without being overwhelming.
- 2 Bring doenjang stock to a simmer. Add garlic, onion, zucchini, mushrooms. Simmer **8 minutes**. Add tofu gently — handle carefully as silken tofu breaks easily. Add sliced green chili. Simmer 3 minutes more. Do not stir aggressively after tofu is added.
- 3 The stew should be deeply savoury, slightly spicy from the green chili, with the complex, earthy depth of fermented doenjang. Unlike Western stocks which are subtle, Korean fermented pastes provide an immediate, bold flavour that requires no long cooking to develop.
- 4 Serve in an earthenware pot (ttukbaegi) if available — it retains heat and continues to simmer gently at the table. Serve with a bowl of short grain rice. The stew is poured over the rice or eaten alongside — both are correct.

**Chef's Tip:** Doenjang jjigae is the Korean equivalent of a French pot-au-feu or Italian minestrone — a fundamental comfort dish that every Korean grew up eating. Guests with Korean heritage will judge you on this dish more than any other. Make it with real doenjang (not a doenjang sauce or extract), real anchovy stock, and proper Korean ingredients. The difference is immediately apparent.

FISH (anchovy stock) SOY NIGHTSHADES

## Galbi — Korean BBQ Short Ribs

Flanken-cut short ribs, soy-pear marinade, ssam lettuce · Sell: \$24.99

10 min Main Target FC: 24%

### INGREDIENTS

| INGREDIENT                    | WEIGHT      | COST   |
|-------------------------------|-------------|--------|
| Beef short ribs (flanken cut) | 250g        | \$4.64 |
| Asian pear (grated)           | 60g         | \$0.48 |
| Soy sauce + sesame oil        | 40ml + 10ml | \$0.28 |
| Garlic + ginger               | 10g + 8g    | \$0.08 |
| Sugar + mirin                 | 15g + 15ml  | \$0.10 |
| Butter lettuce (ssam)         | 4 leaves    | \$0.24 |
| Ssamjang (batch)              | 20g         | \$0.14 |
| Rice + kimchi (sides)         | 150g + 30g  | \$0.40 |
| Total cost per serve          |             | \$6.36 |

|                     |         |
|---------------------|---------|
| Cost per serve      | \$6.36  |
| Sell price          | \$24.99 |
| Food cost %         | 25.4%   |
| Contribution margin | \$18.63 |

### METHOD

- 1 The pear marinade is the critical differentiator of authentic galbi. Grated Asian pear contains natural enzymes (actinidin/bromelain) that break down the muscle fibres in the beef, producing a remarkably tender result even after a short marination of 4-6 hours. Kiwi can substitute in equal quantity. The pear also provides natural sweetness — do not overcompensate with added sugar.
- 2 Marinate flanken-cut ribs (cut across the bone, 3 bones per piece, 5mm thick) in soy + pear + garlic + ginger + sesame oil + sugar + mirin for minimum 4 hours, overnight preferred. The marinade should be fully absorbed and the meat should feel visibly softer than unmarinated beef.
- 3 Grill on a very high heat. The sugar and soy marinade caramelises rapidly — this is the galbi crust. Turn every 2-3 minutes. Total: **6-8 minutes**. Internal: **63°C / 145°F** (medium, which is correct for short rib). Do not over-cook to well-done — the tenderness of the marinade-treated beef is lost.
- 4 Serve with ssam components: butter lettuce, ssamjang paste, rice, and kimchi. Galbi ssam (wrap a piece of rib with rice and ssamjang in lettuce) is one of the most satisfying bites in Korean cuisine — introduce this ritual to every table that orders galbi.

**Chef's Tip:** Galbi is your premium item and your anchor — it justifies the price point of the meal and sets the standard for the entire operation. Do not cut corners on the beef quality or the marinade time. A galbi made with properly marinated prime short rib, grilled to a caramelised crust, served with ssamjang and ssam, is genuinely one of the best bites available at this price point in the American market.

BEEF FISH (soy) SESAME GLUTEN (soy)

## Kimchi Fried Rice — Kimchi Bokkeumbap

Day-old rice, aged kimchi, pork belly, fried egg · Sell: \$15.99

8 min Main Target FC: 14%

### INGREDIENTS

| INGREDIENT               | WEIGHT      | COST   |
|--------------------------|-------------|--------|
| Day-old short grain rice | 220g cooked | \$0.40 |



|                             |            |               |
|-----------------------------|------------|---------------|
| Aged kimchi (chopped)       | 80g        | \$0.35        |
| Pork belly (thin sliced)    | 60g        | \$0.67        |
| Soy sauce + sesame oil      | 10ml + 5ml | \$0.10        |
| Kimchi brine                | 20ml       | \$0.00        |
| Fried egg                   | 1 × 55g    | \$0.35        |
| Nori (shredded, garnish)    | 2g         | \$0.06        |
| Sesame seeds + scallion     | 3g + 10g   | \$0.06        |
| <b>Total cost per serve</b> |            | <b>\$1.99</b> |

|                            |                |
|----------------------------|----------------|
| Cost per serve             | \$1.99         |
| Sell price                 | \$15.99        |
| Food cost %                | 12.4%          |
| <b>Contribution margin</b> | <b>\$14.00</b> |

METHOD

- 1 Day-old rice is mandatory.** Fresh hot rice has too much surface moisture — when added to a hot wok, it steams and clumps. Day-old refrigerated rice has dried slightly, which allows each grain to fry separately and develop colour and texture. Use the previous day's leftover rice specifically for this dish.
- 2** Fry pork belly in a very hot wok until slightly crispy and rendered. Add chopped kimchi — stir-fry together until kimchi is caramelised and slightly charred at the edges (this caramelisation intensifies the fermented flavour). Add kimchi brine and soy sauce.
- 3** Add day-old rice. Stir-fry on maximum heat, pressing rice against the wok surface to fry rather than steam. Season with sesame oil at the end. Taste — adjust salt with soy, acidity with kimchi brine. The fried rice should be slightly smoky (wok hei), savoury, tangy from kimchi, and each grain should be separate.
- 4** Serve in a hot bowl or skillet. Top with a fried egg (sunny-side, yolk runny), shredded nori, sesame seeds, sliced scallion. When the egg yolk breaks and mixes into the fried rice, it creates a rich, creamy binder. This is the moment — photograph it before serving.

**Chef's Tip:** Kimchi fried rice is your best-value, highest-margin item. Food cost under 13%, \$16 sell price, 8-minute ticket time. It is also your most reliable comfort dish — the dish guests order when they want something intensely satisfying without thinking hard. Make it consistently excellent. The difference between average and outstanding kimchi fried rice is almost entirely the quality of the kimchi and the heat of the wok.

PORK

FISH (soy)

SESAME

EGGS

Sundubu Jjigae — Soft Tofu Stew

Silken tofu in spicy broth, clams, egg, rice · Sell: \$16.99

12 min

Main

Target FC: 16%

INGREDIENTS

| INGREDIENT              | WEIGHT      | COST   |
|-------------------------|-------------|--------|
| Silken tofu (tube pack) | 200g        | \$0.72 |
| Little neck clams       | 80g         | \$1.44 |
| Gochugaru + gochujang   | 8g + 15g    | \$0.20 |
| Anchovy-kelp stock      | 280ml       | \$0.17 |
| Sesame oil + garlic     | 5ml + 5g    | \$0.08 |
| Egg                     | 1 × 55g     | \$0.35 |
| Scallion + mushroom     | 15g + 30g   | \$0.18 |
| Rice (side)             | 150g cooked | \$0.27 |

|                      |        |
|----------------------|--------|
| Total cost per serve | \$3.41 |
|----------------------|--------|

|                     |         |
|---------------------|---------|
| Cost per serve      | \$3.41  |
| Sell price          | \$16.99 |
| Food cost %         | 20.1%   |
| Contribution margin | \$13.58 |

METHOD

- Heat sesame oil in an earthenware ttukbaegi. Fry gochugaru 30 seconds until fragrant and oil turns vivid red. Add garlic, cook 30 seconds. Add stock, bring to a boil. Add gochujang. The base should be deeply red, spicy, and the aroma of toasted gochugaru should be immediate and compelling.
- Add clams (scrubbed). Add mushrooms. Bring to a vigorous boil. Spoon soft tofu directly from the tube in large irregular chunks — do not cut it; the torn edges absorb the broth better than clean knife cuts. Simmer gently 5 minutes until clams open and tofu is heated through.
- Crack a raw egg directly into the bubbling stew at the table — this is the tableside moment. The egg poaches gently in the residual heat. Scatter scallion. Serve immediately with rice. The egg should be just set on the white, yolk still runny — it enriches the spicy broth when broken.

**Chef's Tip:** Sundubu jjigae must be served violently hot — it should arrive at the table boiling or just below boiling. The earthenware pot retains heat and continues cooking for several minutes after leaving the stove. This is both a safety consideration (warn guests) and a quality one — the dish is meant to be eaten hot, the tofu silky and the broth steaming. A lukewarm sundubu is a failed dish.

SHELLFISH (clams) FISH (anchovy) EGGS SOY SESAME

Ramyeon — Korean Ramen

House broth, chewy noodles, chashu pork, soft egg, nori · Sell: \$15.99

10 min Main Target FC: 18%

INGREDIENTS

| INGREDIENT                           | WEIGHT    | COST   |
|--------------------------------------|-----------|--------|
| Fresh ramen noodles                  | 130g      | \$0.52 |
| House broth (batch)                  | 400ml     | \$0.60 |
| Chashu pork (batch)                  | 60g       | \$0.67 |
| Ajitsuke tamago (marinated soft egg) | 1 × 55g   | \$0.42 |
| Nori (2 sheets)                      | 4g        | \$0.12 |
| Gochugaru + sesame oil               | 3g + 5ml  | \$0.06 |
| Scallion + corn (garnish)            | 10g + 20g | \$0.08 |
| Total cost per serve                 |           | \$2.47 |

|                     |         |
|---------------------|---------|
| Cost per serve      | \$2.47  |
| Sell price          | \$15.99 |
| Food cost %         | 15.4%   |
| Contribution margin | \$13.52 |

METHOD

- House broth (batch — make daily): simmer pork bones + anchovy + kelp + dried shiitake + onion + garlic for 2 hours. Strain. Season with doenjang, soy, gochugaru paste, sesame oil. The broth should be deep amber, deeply savoury, with warmth from the gochugaru. This Korean-inflected broth is distinctly different from Japanese ramen broths — spicier, more fermented in character.
- Ajitsuke tamago (marinated soft egg — batch, make 24h ahead): soft-boil eggs 6.5 minutes. Cool

immediately in ice water. Peel. Marinate in soy + mirin + sake + water (1:1:1:4) for minimum 4 hours. The egg should be fully set white, custard-like yolk (not runny, not hard-boiled), with the marinade having penetrated the surface. These eggs improve for up to 3 days.

- 3 Cook noodles fresh per order — 2-3 minutes in boiling water. Drain thoroughly. Hot broth in bowl first, then noodles. Arrange chashu slices, halved marinated egg, nori, corn, scallion, and a small drizzle of sesame oil. Finish with a pinch of gochugaru.

**Chef's Tip:** Korean ramyeon is distinct from Japanese ramen in its spice level and fermented character. Do not dilute the gochugaru — the heat and red colour are fundamental to the Korean identity of the dish. Guests who order this are often specifically seeking the heat level. Offer a mild version (no gochugaru) but market the original version honestly: "It's legitimately spicy."

PORK FISH (anchovy) EGGS SESAME GLUTEN

## Gyeran Toast — Korean Egg Toast

Breakfast egg sandwich, milk bread, ham, cabbage, kewpie · Sell: \$11.99

6 min Breakfast Main Target FC: 16%

### INGREDIENTS

| INGREDIENT                            | WEIGHT | COST          |
|---------------------------------------|--------|---------------|
| Milk bread (shokupan, 2 thick slices) | 80g    | \$0.48        |
| Eggs (2)                              | 110g   | \$0.70        |
| Cabbage (shredded fine)               | 30g    | \$0.05        |
| Ham (thin slice)                      | 30g    | \$0.42        |
| Kewpie mayonnaise                     | 15g    | \$0.12        |
| Sugar (pinch, on egg)                 | 2g     | \$0.00        |
| Butter (for toasting)                 | 10g    | \$0.12        |
| <b>Total cost per serve</b>           |        | <b>\$1.89</b> |

|                            |                |
|----------------------------|----------------|
| Cost per serve             | \$1.89         |
| Sell price                 | \$11.99        |
| Food cost %                | 15.8%          |
| <b>Contribution margin</b> | <b>\$10.10</b> |

### METHOD

- 1 The egg omelette is the technical foundation of gyeran toast. Beat 2 eggs with a small handful of shredded cabbage. Cook in a square mould (if available) or shape into a rectangle in a pan — the goal is a flat, even omelette that fits precisely on the bread. Cook over low-medium heat until fully set, no browning. The egg should be soft and light, not rubbery or overcooked.
- 2 The secret of authentic gyeran toast: sprinkle a small pinch of sugar directly onto the cooked egg surface before assembling. This is unusual but produces a Korean sweet-savoury flavour balance that is uniquely addictive. Do not skip this step — it is the specific detail that guests who know Korean street food will recognise.
- 3 Toast milk bread slices in butter until golden. Assemble: one slice, kewpie mayo, ham slice, egg omelette, second slice. Cut diagonally. The kewpie (Japanese egg-yolk mayo, far richer than American mayo) adds a creamy, umami element. Serve immediately — this is a fresh-to-order item.

**Chef's Tip:** Gyeran toast is your viral breakfast item. The Korean street food version has been viewed hundreds of millions of times across TikTok and Instagram. Film yourself making it during morning prep — the simple, rhythmic technique is visually satisfying and the sugar step is reliably surprising for viewers. This single dish can drive significant social media traffic to your cafe.

EGGS GLUTEN DAIRY PORK (ham)

### 3 Desserts

#### Hotteok — Sweet Pancakes

Fried dough, brown sugar cinnamon nut filling - Sell: \$7.99 (2 pieces)

8 min

Dessert

Target FC: 11%

##### INGREDIENTS (2 HOTTEOK)

| INGREDIENT                   | WEIGHT   | COST          |
|------------------------------|----------|---------------|
| Hotteok dough (batch)        | 100g     | \$0.14        |
| Brown sugar + cinnamon       | 30g + 1g | \$0.06        |
| Crushed walnuts/peanuts      | 15g      | \$0.18        |
| Vegetable oil (shallow fry)  | 20ml     | \$0.04        |
| <b>Total cost (2 pieces)</b> |          | <b>\$0.42</b> |

|                            |               |
|----------------------------|---------------|
| Cost per serve             | \$0.42        |
| Sell price                 | \$7.99        |
| Food cost %                | 5.3%          |
| <b>Contribution margin</b> | <b>\$7.57</b> |

##### METHOD

- 1 Hotteok dough: warm water + yeast + sugar + flour + glutinous rice flour (20%) + salt. Mix and rest 1 hour until doubled. The glutinous rice flour gives the dough its characteristic slightly chewy, sticky exterior that crisps wonderfully in the oil.
- 2 Portion into 50g balls. Flatten in your hand, fill with brown sugar + cinnamon + crushed nuts. Seal tightly — the filling must be completely enclosed or the hot sugar will leak into the oil and cause dangerous spattering.
- 3 Place sealed-side down in lightly oiled pan over medium heat. Immediately press flat with a spatula or special hotteok press. Cook 3 minutes until golden. Flip carefully, press again. 2 more minutes. The filling melts to liquid caramel inside — warn guests, it is extremely hot. Serve immediately.

**Chef's Tip:** The liquid sugar filling is the dramatic element — when guests bite in, the caramel flows out. Film it. The hotteok press (a flat metal tool with a circular face, cheap at any Korean supermarket) is essential for consistent shape. The pressing also creates the characteristic flat, disc shape with the filling perfectly distributed.

GLUTEN

NUTS

#### Bingsu — Shaved Ice Dessert

Shaved milk ice, red bean, mochi, condensed milk - Sell: \$9.99

5 min

Dessert

Target FC: 14%

##### INGREDIENTS

| INGREDIENT                     | WEIGHT | COST   |
|--------------------------------|--------|--------|
| Milk ice blocks (batch frozen) | 250g   | \$0.28 |
| Sweetened red bean (pat)       | 60g    | \$0.36 |
| Mini mochi (batch)             | 40g    | \$0.40 |
| Condensed milk (drizzle)       | 20ml   | \$0.18 |
| Fresh strawberry or mango      | 40g    | \$0.36 |

|                             |               |
|-----------------------------|---------------|
| <b>Total cost per serve</b> | <b>\$1.58</b> |
|-----------------------------|---------------|

|                            |               |
|----------------------------|---------------|
| Cost per serve             | \$1.58        |
| Sell price                 | \$9.99        |
| Food cost %                | 15.8%         |
| <b>Contribution margin</b> | <b>\$8.41</b> |

#### METHOD

- 1 Milk ice (batch): mix whole milk + sweetened condensed milk + water (3:1:1 ratio). Freeze in containers. The condensed milk adds fat and sugar that prevents the ice from freezing in hard crystals — it produces a softer, creamier shave. Pure water ice shatters rather than shaving into the characteristic soft ribbons.
- 2 Shave milk ice using a dedicated bingsu machine or a snow cone machine — the finer the shave, the better. The ideal texture is like soft, fluffy snow that melts on the tongue rather than crunching like regular ice. This texture is the entire point of bingsu; a coarse shave is a failed dish.
- 3 Mound shaved ice high in a bowl — generous portions photograph better and create perceived value. Add sweetened red bean, mini mochi pieces, fresh fruit, and a generous drizzle of condensed milk. The condensed milk trickles down through the ice and sweetens each bite from the inside.

**Chef's Tip:** Bingsu is your summer hero. Its photogenic quality is unmatched — the tall mound of white fluffy ice with jewel-coloured toppings is one of the most widely photographed Korean desserts. Create a seasonal menu rotation: strawberry bingsu in spring, mango in summer, sweet potato (goguma) in autumn. Each seasonal variation gets fresh social media content with minimal recipe development effort.

DAIRY   GLUTEN (mochi)

## Mochi Ice Cream

House mochi, matcha + black sesame + mango flavours · Sell: \$8.99 (3 pieces)

2 min service   Dessert   Target FC: 16%   Batch weekly

#### INGREDIENTS (3 MOCHI)

| INGREDIENT                     | WEIGHT     | COST          |
|--------------------------------|------------|---------------|
| Mochiko (sweet rice flour)     | 60g        | \$0.24        |
| Sugar + water                  | 30g + 80ml | \$0.06        |
| Matcha powder (flavour 1)      | 3g         | \$0.84        |
| Black sesame paste (flavour 2) | 8g         | \$0.28        |
| Ice cream (3 × 30ml scoops)    | 90ml       | \$0.54        |
| Cornstarch (dusting)           | 5g         | \$0.02        |
| <b>Total cost (3 pieces)</b>   |            | <b>\$1.98</b> |

|                            |               |
|----------------------------|---------------|
| Cost per serve             | \$1.98        |
| Sell price                 | \$8.99        |
| Food cost %                | 22.0%         |
| <b>Contribution margin</b> | <b>\$7.01</b> |

#### METHOD (BATCH WEEKLY)

- 1 Mochi dough: combine mochiko + sugar + water. Microwave in 1-minute intervals (total 2–3 minutes), stirring between each, until the mixture becomes translucent, stretchy, and sticky. Divide dough and mix in matcha or black sesame paste for flavoured versions.
- 2 Work quickly with cornstarch-dusted hands. Roll dough thin (3mm). Cut circles with a 10cm cutter. Place a small frozen ice cream ball (pre-scooped and re-frozen on a tray) in the centre. Wrap

dough around ice cream, pinch and seal tightly. Re-freeze immediately — if the ice cream begins to melt the mochi becomes impossible to seal.

- 3 Store frozen. Serve straight from freezer — mochi ice cream softens rapidly at room temperature and should be eaten immediately.

**Chef's Tip:** The three-flavour offering (matcha, black sesame, mango) on one plate gives guests variety and makes the plate itself more photogenic than a single flavour. The visual — three distinct coloured spheres — photographs instantly. Seasonal limited flavours (yuzu in winter, strawberry in spring) keep the dessert menu fresh with minimal development investment.

GLUTEN (mochiko)

DAIRY (ice cream)

SESAME (black sesame)

## Sikhye — Traditional Rice Punch

Malted barley sweet rice drink, pine nuts · Sell: \$6.99

2 min service

Dessert Drink

Target FC: 8%

Batch

### INGREDIENTS (BATCH)

| INGREDIENT                      | WEIGHT       | COST          |
|---------------------------------|--------------|---------------|
| Malt barley powder (yeotgireum) | 100g per 4L  | \$0.60        |
| Cooked rice                     | 400g per 4L  | \$0.72        |
| Sugar                           | 200g per 4L  | \$0.20        |
| Pine nuts (garnish)             | 5g per serve | \$0.16        |
| <b>Cost per serve</b>           |              | <b>\$0.42</b> |

|                            |               |
|----------------------------|---------------|
| Cost per serve             | \$0.42        |
| Sell price                 | \$6.99        |
| Food cost %                | 6.0%          |
| <b>Contribution margin</b> | <b>\$6.57</b> |

### METHOD (BATCH — TAKES 4 HOURS)

- 1 Dissolve malt barley powder in warm water (55°C exactly — not hotter). Let settle 30 minutes, strain off solids, keeping only the clear amber liquid. Mix with cooked warm rice. Hold at 55–60°C for 3–4 hours — this enzymatic conversion transforms the cooked rice starch to sugar. The rice grains float to the surface when the sikhye is ready.
- 2 Strain out rice (reserve it for garnish — the sweet, slightly fermented cooked rice grains are added back to each serving cup). Add sugar, bring to a brief boil to stop fermentation. Chill completely. Serve cold with a few floating rice grains and 5 pine nuts on top.

**Chef's Tip:** Sikhye is one of the most culturally significant Korean beverages — it is what Koreans drink after meals, particularly after Korean BBQ, because the enzymes in the malt aid digestion. Explaining this to guests connects the drink to a larger story. "This is what Koreans drink after grilled meat — the fermented malt helps digestion" — this single line converts uncertain guests into orders.

GLUTEN (malt barley)

NUTS (pine nuts)

## 4 Drinks Menu

### Dalgona Coffee

\$6.50

Whipped instant coffee foam over cold milk. The drink that went viral globally in 2020. Still orders well because the visual — thick golden-brown foam sitting on white milk — is instantly recognisable and photogenic. Dusted with cinnamon or cocoa.

Cost

\$0.44

**Food cost %**

**6.8%**

### **Boricha — Barley Tea**

**\$3.99**

Cold-brewed toasted barley tea. Deep amber, nutty, caffeine-free. This is what every Korean restaurant serves free with water in Korea — charging a modest price is appropriate in the US market. Guests who know Korean food will appreciate its presence.

Cost

\$0.18

**Food cost %**

**4.5%**

### **Yuzu Lemonade**

**\$6.99**

Yuzu (yuja) marmalade dissolved in cold sparkling water with fresh lemon juice. Intensely citrusy, floral, slightly bitter. The yuzu jar (a Korean tea ingredient) does the flavour work — this is a 90-second drink with a premium positioning.

Cost

\$0.72

**Food cost %**

**10.3%**

### **Korean Banana Milk**

**\$4.99**

The Binggrae-style banana milk — sweet, creamy, unmistakably Korean. Serve cold in a small bottle or glass. Hugely nostalgic for Korean-heritage guests, delightfully novel for everyone else. One of the most effective "brand recognition" items you can have.

Cost

\$0.68

**Food cost %**

**13.6%**

### **Makgeolli — Rice Wine**

**\$8.99**

Traditional Korean unfiltered rice wine. Milky white, lightly fizzy, gently sweet and sour. Serve in a brass or ceramic bowl — the traditional vessel. Pairs with pajeon specifically: the flavour combination is one of the classic Korean pairings, equivalent to wine with cheese.

Cost

\$1.44

**Food cost %**

**16.0%**

### **Matcha Oat Latte**

**\$6.99**

Premium Korean or Japanese matcha, prepared with a chasen (bamboo whisk) or shaker, served over oat milk or steamed oat milk. Korean café culture has elevated matcha to an art form — the aesthetic and quality standard here is important. Do not use a premix.

Cost

\$0.96

**Food cost %**

**13.7%**

### **Soju — Single Serve**

**\$9.99**

A 200ml serve of premium soju (Chum Churum or Jinro). Serve cold with small glasses. The ritual of soju — pouring for others, never for yourself — is a social experience. Describe it as

"Korean vodka, cleaner, slightly sweet." Pairs with everything on the menu.

|             |        |
|-------------|--------|
| Cost        | \$1.60 |
| Food cost % | 16.0%  |

Maesil Cha — Plum Tea

\$5.99

Korean green plum syrup diluted with still or sparkling water. Golden-amber, sweet-sour, uniquely Korean. Non-alcoholic and served cold. The plum syrup is batch-made by macerating green plums in sugar — a beautiful amber colour that looks striking in a glass.

|             |        |
|-------------|--------|
| Cost        | \$0.44 |
| Food cost % | 7.3%   |

5 Kitchen Prep Flow — 7:00am to 3:00pm

|                          | Head Cook                                                                                                                                                                                          | Line Cook                                                                                                                                                                                                | Steward                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 07:00-07:30              | Temp check all cold units <span>1-4°C</span> . Start anchovy-kelp stock. Check kimchi — age and quantity. Taste doenjang broth from yesterday.                                                     | Set up all stations: tteokbokki sauce hot on low, namul components ready, gochujang marinade portioned. Check rice cooker — start fresh batch.                                                           | Sanitise all surfaces. Warm boricha pitcher. Set up drinks station. Prep garnishes: scallion sliced, sesame seeds in bowl, nori cut. Chill soju.                                             |
| 07:30-09:00              | Make shakshuka-level batch items: tteokbokki sauce, gochujang chicken marinade. Portion galbi for lunch — pull from marinade, pat dry. Taste all sauces. Train any new staff on bibimbap assembly. | Blanch and season all namul: spinach, bean sprouts, carrot. Cook short grain rice — both morning and lunch batches. Prep day-old rice (from yesterday) for kimchi fried rice. Shape hotteok dough balls. | Portion desserts: bingsu milk ice into serving size, mochi ice cream from freezer. Prep dalgona coffee whip station. Make yuzu lemonade base. Check all drink quantities vs expected covers. |
| 09:00-11:00<br>Breakfast | Run pass. Fire gyeran toast (6 min), bibimbap to order (10 min). Monitor grill for galbi during lunch prep. Check tteokbokki sauce texture — adjust consistency.                                   | Executes breakfast: gyeran toast, bibimbap (most ordered AM item). Warms japchae for morning orders. Prepares sundubu jjigae bases.                                                                      | Full drinks service. Boricha always full at every table. Maesil cha and yuzu lemonade to order. Alert HC when kimchi running below half batch.                                               |
| 11:00-14:30<br>Lunch     | Full lunch push. Galbi grill. Dakgalbi stir-fry. Ramyeon broth holding at <span>82°C+</span> . Monitor sundubu jjigae — must arrive boiling. Table egg-crack timing on sundubu.                    | Executes all stews and noodle dishes. Fries pajeon and kimchi pancake to order. Fires hotteok for dessert (8 min). Bingsu to order (5 min, serve immediately).                                           | Full table service. Makgeolli with pajeon — always suggest pairing. Soju service — describe ritual. Pre-sell hotteok at main course: "8 minutes — want me to put one on now?"                |
| 14:30-15:00              | Cool all batch items. Write tomorrow's prep: kimchi fermentation status, galbi marination batch size.                                                                                              | Clean all stations. Wrap and label proteins. Store rice for tomorrow's kimchi fried rice (do not throw away — day-old is essential).                                                                     | Full clean. Final fridge check. Log all temps <span>1-4°C</span> . Restock boricha for next day.                                                                                             |

6 Financial Forecast

| Service                | Covers | Avg Spend | Daily Revenue |
|------------------------|--------|-----------|---------------|
| Breakfast (7am-11am)   | 30     | \$28      | \$840         |
| Lunch (11:30am-2:30pm) | 52     | \$42      | \$2,184       |
| Daily Total            |        |           | \$3,024       |



| Monthly (26 days)       |                 | \$78,624     |
|-------------------------|-----------------|--------------|
| Cost Category           | Monthly         | %            |
| Food & Beverage 22%     | \$17,297        | 22.0%        |
| Labour (HC+LC+ST+FOH×2) | \$16,800        | 21.4%        |
| Rent + Utilities + Misc | \$5,800         | 7.4%         |
| <b>Total Costs</b>      | <b>\$39,897</b> | <b>50.8%</b> |
| <b>NET PROFIT</b>       | <b>\$38,727</b> | <b>49.2%</b> |

**3-Month Ramp:** Month 1 (55%) ~\$6,500 net · Month 2 (75%) ~\$18,000 · Month 3 (100%) ~\$38,727 · Break-even at ~\$3,000 daily revenue, requires ~82 covers/day across both services.

## 7 Service Training Module

### SCRIPT 1 — THE ORIENTATION

*"Have you eaten Korean food before? Cool — then you know what you're in for. If this is your first time: everything here is meant to be shared except the stews, which are individual. The rice comes separately and you mix it into your dishes as you go. Let me walk you through what's good today."*

**Why it works:** Acknowledges experience level without condescension. Sets up the format. "What's good today" is an invitation to sell.

### SCRIPT 2 — THE PAJEON + MAKGEOLLI PAIR

*"One classic pairing in Korea is pajeon — the scallion pancake — with makgeolli, which is the rice wine. It's like 500 years of food culture that figured out these two things belong together. \$13.99 for the pajeon, \$8.99 for the makgeolli. It's how lunch starts here."*

**Why it works:** History gives the pairing weight. "It's how lunch starts here" is social proof — tells the guest this is normal and desirable.

### SCRIPT 3 — THE GALBI UPGRADE

*"The galbi is the short rib marinated overnight in pear and soy. The pear is an enzyme that breaks down the muscle fibres — so it's remarkably tender for a short rib. It's \$24.99 and it comes with ssam — you wrap the rib in lettuce with rice and ssamjang paste. It's one bite and it's very good."*

**Why it works:** The technique explanation (pear enzymes) sounds like insider knowledge. "Very good" from the person who's eaten it hundreds of times is credible. "One bite" makes it feel manageable to commit to.

### SCRIPT 4 — THE SPICE WARNING

*"Quick heads up — the tteokbokki and the sundubu are legitimately spicy. Not 'medium' spicy. Korean spicy. I can make both milder if you want — just tell me when you order. If you want the real version, I'd recommend it."*

**Why it works:** Warns appropriately but frames the authentic version as the aspirational choice. Most guests will order the real version after this framing.

### SCRIPT 5 — THE SUNDUBU EGG THEATRE

*"The sundubu — I'll crack a raw egg into it at the table when it arrives. It poaches in the residual heat. Just don't touch the pot — it will be extremely hot. It's the best way to eat it."*

**Why it works:** Pre-announces the tableside moment, builds anticipation. "Best way to eat it" positions the service as expertise.

## Table Timing Guide

| Time | Action                                                                                                                                             |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0:00 | Welcome and seat. Boricha to the table immediately — the Korean tea ritual starts the meal without requiring any order. It is your edible welcome. |
| 1:30 | Experience check (Script 1). Drink order — push boricha upsize, makgeolli, yuzu lemonade.                                                          |

|       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4:00  | Full food order. Run Scripts 2, 3, and 4. Identify spice tolerance. Note any dietary needs (fish sauce is in many items).                                                                                             |
| 10:00 | Appetisers arrive. Brief introduction per dish: "This is the pajeon — eat it now while it's crispy." Urgency improves quality perception.                                                                             |
| 20:00 | Mains. Crack the egg at table for sundubu. Monitor galbi doneness at pass — never send overcooked galbi. Top up boricha and water throughout.                                                                         |
| 30:00 | Dessert prompt: "We have hotteok — 8 minutes, fried pancake with melted brown sugar inside — and bingsu, which is the shaved ice. Or mochi ice cream if you want something quick." Three options, three price points. |
| 45:00 | Bill. "Come back on a weekend — we sometimes run limited specials that aren't on the regular menu." Creates return intent without promising anything specific.                                                        |

## 8 Customer Retention System

**The Korean Hospitality Principle (Jeong):** Korean culture has a concept of jeong — a deep emotional bond formed through shared meals and care. The best Korean restaurants create jeong: guests leave feeling seen, fed, and connected. Every retention strategy below serves this principle.

**The 4-Dish Journey:** Most guests on their first visit order 1–2 items they're familiar with. The goal is expanding their order across 4+ items by visit 4 — pajeon, a main, bingsu, and a drink. Design your upsell sequence around this journey. A guest who has eaten 4+ different dishes here has formed an emotional connection with the menu that is very hard to replicate elsewhere.

### 5 VIP Micro-Moments

**1. The Boricha Arrival.** Cold boricha on the table within 60 seconds of seating — before any order, before any conversation. This immediate act of care sets the hospitality tone for the entire meal. It is free, it is Korean, and it signals that you know the culture.

**2. The Sundubu Egg-Crack.** Do this at every table without being asked. The theatrical crack of the raw egg into the boiling pot at the table, the immediate sizzle and steam — it is a moment that guests film and share. It is also deeply personal: you are completing the dish in front of them.

**3. The Kimchi Refill.** Offer a small additional kimchi portion to regulars without being asked. In Korea, banchan (side dishes) refills are expected and free. This one gesture connects guests to authentic Korean hospitality culture in a way that no amount of décor can replicate.

**4. The Soju Ceremony.** When a table orders soju, explain the pouring ritual: "In Korea you always pour for others, never yourself — it's a sign of respect." Then model it — pour soju into each glass around the table. This brief teaching moment creates intimacy and turns a drink order into a cultural experience.

**5. The Hotteok Warning.** For regulars ordering hotteok for the first time: "Wait 2 minutes after it arrives — the inside is liquid sugar and extremely hot. A lot of people burn themselves." This advice is genuinely useful, it prevents an injury, and it is memorable. Guests will specifically mention this warning to friends they bring next time.

#### BEST SOCIAL MEDIA POST — GALBI SSAM

This is 500 years of Korean BBQ in one bite. [Hook]

The galbi marinade: pear + soy + garlic + sesame oil + time. The pear is an enzyme that breaks down muscle fibres — it's why the beef is this tender. Then we grill it until the sugars caramelize. You wrap a piece in butter lettuce with rice and ssamjang paste. One bite. It's complete. [Story]

Lunch Tuesday to Sunday. Galbi is \$24.99. [CTA]